

University Of Warwick - Warwick Business School

IB9ZH0 Project Management

Individual Assignment

**Project Management at Formula One World
Championship Limited**

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1. Introduction

To me, Formula One World Championship Limited (F1) represents my ideal workplace because it ties together 4 distinct entities: a sport, an entertainment venue, a technological achievement, and an international storytelling brand. The difficulty of communicating a "product" that serves both a very technologically advanced fan base, as well as an expanding mainstream audience, intrigues me significantly, and qualifies F1 as my dream job. My interest in F1 is not just from; however, as the coordinator of content strategy, social media campaigns and brand development on a student run fashion website (CasaVyoMay), I gained a significant amount of experience managing large scale audience development and campaign planning. The level of cross-functional collaboration that goes into building a successful marketing program is very unique in an organisational structure such as F1.

As part of my research for this project, I analysed F1's project management (PM) maturity and culture, and proposed a hypothetical new project: the F1 Fan Intelligence and Campaign Optimisation Programme. To analyse this program I used two key areas of PM practice, risk management and integrated planning, as well as qualitative and quantitative analysis to evaluate the project management principles associated with managing this type of project.

2. PM Maturity and Culture of Formula One

F1 would sit between Levels 4 and 5 of the PMMM Administratively Managed and Optimising (Kerzner, H., 2022). This evaluation is based on the established governance structure of the organisation; effective global coordination through a 24-race calendar; and F1's established capacity to improve operations continuously. Since acquiring F1 in 2017, Liberty Media has invested in centralised systems for delivering services, digital transformation, sustainable programmes, and has generated \$3.41 Billion in revenue for 2024 (Liberty Media, 2025). F1 operates multiple projects at the same time, including logistics management, broadcasting management, commercial management, safety, and regulatory functions; hence, the complexity of the work at F1 substantiates F1's high level of PM maturity.

F1 has a project environment similar to that found in a high reliability organisation (Weick and Sutcliffe, 2007), with an emphasis on learning from both successful and unsuccessful operations. There is embedded risk, but there is variability in the level of project management maturity in the various functions. For example, in the marketing and communications function, governance of projects is less formalised than in race operations.

As a result, a number of marketing and communications activities, such as campaign delivery, fan engagement initiatives and brand partnership activations, are not consistently performed using PM tools; therefore, structured benefits realisation tracking and earned value analysis are not evident in the marketing function. The DRIVE to Survive era 2022-2024 fan growth campaigns were commercially successful; however, the campaigns were predominantly treated as creative projects and therefore lacked measurable outcome frameworks and formal project governance (Formula One, 2025).

Stakeholder governance and the integration of sustainability are primary drivers of PM maturity in project-based organisations (Al-Marri, Abdalla and Mahdi, 2025). In the marketing function of F1, the stakeholder governance framework extends to teams and sponsors, broadcasters, and fan communities across different cultures and platforms. Therefore, the governance framework used to manage a complex stakeholder governance environment in F1 is comparatively underdeveloped. This is the research gap that my proposed study will directly address.

3. Theme One: Risk Management

3.1 The Proposed Project:

My first-choice project will be the F1 Fan Intelligence and Campaign Optimisation Programme, this is an initiative to develop the first integrated fan data and marketing campaign management platform for Formula 1. The data that is available for marketing purposes is currently disjointed; race attendance records, social media analytics, streaming behaviour, app usage and survey results all exist in separate places, therefore fans are not able to be targeted and engaged as effectively as they could be. FICOP will establish a central fan intelligence layer that will link the aforementioned data sources, provide insights into how to segment fans and give campaign teams access to real-time performance dashboards. The estimated budget for FICOP will be £22 million and will cover platform development, data infrastructure, campaign tools and training over three years.

3.2 Risk Management Framework:

FICOP faces significant uncertainty as it relates to confidential fan information, regulatory challenges due to its multiple markets and dependencies on third-party platforms. I intend to utilise a course consisting of both qualitative and quantitative risk analyses. Traditional probability-impact matrix should be augmented with simulation-type analysis in order to

avoid an oversimplified ranking of priorities (Acebes et al., 2024a), which is particularly pertinent to FICOP's data-intensive nature, where the costs and schedules are very dependent upon one another.

Risk	Probability	Impact	Priority	Response
GDPR / data privacy non-compliance	Medium	High	High	Legal review embedded at each gate
Third-party platform API changes	High	High	Extreme	Vendor contracts with SLA protections
Fan data quality inconsistencies	High	Medium	High	Data audit before architecture build
Cost escalation	Medium	High	High	Monte Carlo baseline (see Section 3.3)
Internal adoption failure	Medium	Medium	Moderate	Change management and training plan

The third-party platform dependency poses a highly significant risk to F1. F1's marketing campaigns heavily depend on Social Media - all third-party platforms whose access to their APIs, algorithms and content monetisation policies are wholly uncontrolled by F1. I saw an example of this risk while at CasaVyoMay when Instagram made an algorithm change mid-campaign that resulted in a drastic reduction of organic reach for our content. This unexpected, required us to pivot our distribution strategy and significantly increased both our timeline and costs. At F1's scale, any platform-side changes could impact campaigns delivering to hundreds of millions of fans. FICOP therefore should create an agnostic data architecture instead of building to a specific API, which will increase the complexity of development but also decrease future risk exposure.

3.3 Quantitative Risk: Monte Carlo Simulation:

In order to combat the well-documented optimism bias in large-scale projects (Flyvbjerg, 2023), I will employ Monte Carlo simulation to establish a £22 million cost baseline. The following describes the cost distribution resulting from 10,000 replications.

Percentile	Projected Cost	Interpretation
P50 (most likely)	£24.1m	Base case outcome
P80 (recommended baseline)	£26.8m	Recommended control budget

P95 (stress scenario)	£30.2m	Reserve trigger point
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As such, I would recommend the P80 figure of £26.8m be set as the official control budget with a centrally held 15% contingency. With regard to the highest-uncertainty activities, based on Activity Risk Index methodology (Acebes et al., 2024b), multi-platform data integration, GDPR sign-off across all race host jurisdictions, and live testing of campaign dashboards during race weekends (where the operational pressure is the highest and the errors are the most visible) will be identified as high-priority control points for monitoring the budget and schedule.

3.4 Improving Risk Management at F1:

F1 currently does not have a formal risk governance structure for its marketing function. This is why I would like to propose implementing a Marketing Risk Register into the operations of the communications team as a standing governance tool set to be reviewed on a quarterly basis and updated prior to each campaign cycle. Establishing a marketing risk register and connecting it to a portfolio-level risk dashboard will enable F1's marketing function to transition from reactive incident management to anticipatory risk planning, which would represent a significant advancement in PM maturity for the function I am hoping to work with.

4. Theme Two: Integrated Planning

4.1 Integrated Planning's Importance for FICOP:

FICOP represents a marketing transformation effort that has a component of delivering data infrastructure. This distinction is crucial when it comes to planning. Systems integration is an essential skill set on complex projects (PMI, 2021); without this integration, scope, cost, schedule, risk and benefit will be managed in isolation and yield fragmented delivery. The FICOP project has many stakeholders: F1 marketing strategy teams, data/analytics, legal and compliance, technology vendors, broadcast partners and marketing leaders from 24 regional race markets. If the stakeholders plan in isolation, they will create the same type of disconnected data environment that FICOP seeks to eliminate.

4.2 Hybrid Planning Framework:

A hybrid Agile-Stage-Gate planning framework will be used. The platform development and campaign tooling will benefit from an iterative delivery approach since marketing continually

evolves, and the early feedback provided by users of the campaigns will help to inform the design of the platform. Stage Gates will be necessary to provide the rigor needed for all major investment decisions. The three gates will include:

Gate 1: Approval of data architecture and privacy framework.

Gate 2: Authorization to complete the pilot in a single market (UK) prior to rolling out.

Gate 3: Approval for global rollout based on evaluations of the pilot.

I have experienced that the combination of creative flexibility and investment accountability I found crucial at CasaVyoMay allowed campaigns with defined milestones to continually exceed those with undefined milestones.

4.3 Work Breakdown Structure:

Level 2 Workpackages for WBS:

Workpackage	Key Activities
1. Data Architecture	Fan data audit, platform-agnostic API design, data warehouse build
2. Audience Intelligence Layer	Segmentation models, behavioural analytics, real-time dashboards
3. Campaign Management Tooling	Planning templates, A/B testing framework, performance tracking
4. Pilot Deployment (UK)	Single-market test, user acceptance testing, iteration sprint
5. Global Rollout	24-market deployment, regional training, benefits tracking activation

The decomposition identifies scope, allocates cost responsibility between each level 2 workpackage, provides relevant information to the RACI matrix and clearly defines the boundary between Central Marketing and Regional Communications Lead roles. One of the top causes of delay on cross-functional marketing projects at CasaVyoMay is the ambiguity around this boundary area; at the scale of F1, delays could have a much larger impact.

4.4 Critical Path (CP) and Schedule:

Critical Path Analysis has identified a project duration of 32 months with the following critical activities:

Activity	Duration	Critical?
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Data audit and architecture design	4 months	Yes
Privacy framework and GDPR sign-off	4 months	Yes
Platform development (core)	8 months	Yes
UK pilot and iteration	4 months	Yes
Global rollout and training	7 months	Yes
Campaign tooling build	5 months	No (parallel)
Internal training design	3 months	No (parallel)

GDPR Sign-off Workpackage is a high risk to the schedule because it relies on simultaneous Legal Review across all 24 race hosting jurisdictions. The process is both sequential in some of those jurisdictions and politically charged in others. Idle time exists in the non-critical workloads so that if the Critical Path is threatened there are other resources to deploy.

4.5 Earned Value Management

EVM would be used to manage the timeline and budget of the project throughout the delivery period, and to provide an early warning of potential problems. The value of EVM is illustrated in the graph in month 12, which shows that both the SPI and CPI are below 1, signalling a need to take immediate corrective action. Specifically, I would recommend re-baselining the GDPR workpackage timeline, redeploying resources from float activities, and escalating to a Gate 2 readiness review. The important thing about EVM is the timing, not the actual SPI and CPI numbers themselves; identifying a 20% cost overrun in month 12 as opposed to month 24 provides significantly different options for recovering the project and avoids last-minute crisis management, which is common in undervalued projects (Flyvbjerg 2023).

EVM Metric	Value	Interpretation
Planned Value (PV)	£8.9m	Budget allocated to date
Earned Value (EV)	£7.6m	Work completed in budget terms
Actual Cost (AC)	£9.5m	Actual expenditure to date
Schedule Performance Index (SPI)	0.85	Behind schedule
Cost Performance Index (CPI)	0.80	Over budget

4.6 Benefits Realisation Planning

One of the major weaknesses in marketing project management has been the lack of a formalised process for capturing post-delivery benefits. Marketing campaigns are usually launched and evaluated based upon vanity metrics rather than outcome metrics. I propose implementing a Benefits Realisation Map at project initiation.

Level	Example for FICOP
Output	Integrated fan data platform live across 24 markets
Outcome	Campaign teams make audience decisions using unified data rather than siloed analytics
Benefit	15% improvement in campaign conversion rates; 20% reduction in wasted campaign spend
Strategic Value	F1 builds the most data-sophisticated fan marketing capability in global sport

The information presented supports how projects should also be evaluated in terms of factors other than time, cost and scope (ie "the iron triangle") (Shenhar and Dvir, 2007). The framework creates feedback loops whereby every time the audience receives an audience measurement cycle, the FICOP provides feedback into the refinement of the audiences it targets.

4.7 Improving Integrated Planning at F1

F1's marketing plans on the basis of a "race by race" or "season by season" campaign, without any ongoing integration between the marketing strategy, the data, the digital and the communications work streams at the level of an entire programme. I would suggest the following three systematic improvements:

1. An annual marketing calendar treated as one integrated contract, with common planning assumptions, risk information and resource decisions made at a portfolio level rather than at a campaign level.
2. Pre-season digital scenario planning embedded into the marketing strategy, to allow modelling of how audiences behave across various race formats and how to allocate budgets.
3. A post-campaign benefits review process that reviews pre-defined outcomes against actual results to determine the return on investment for each campaign and using the output from those evaluations to influence planning for the next campaign.

5. Conclusion

F1 demonstrates that it has a mature operating level of project management. However, its marketing and communications area lacks the same structure around project management as other F1 operations do. The proposed F1 Fan Intelligence & Campaign Optimisation Programme demonstrates how using Integrated Planning and Risk Management can work together to create a step change in the way you approach your marketing. By using Monte Carlo simulations, the process of contingencies isn't as much of a guessing game; the stage gate of projects offers a means to prevent premature scaling; EVM provides an early opportunity to detect performance issues; and through the mapping of benefits realisation to a project ensures that the value of the project is recognised and captured vs. assumed when the project is finished.

I have previously managed content campaigns and brand outreach at CasaVyoMay, giving me a better understanding than most of the gaps in governance that FICOP is going to help close: the fragility of platform dependent marketing, the expenses of not having a defined milestone process, and the difference between measuring an output and measuring an outcome.

Appendix

Appendix A — Monte Carlo Cost Simulation Summary (FICOP)

Scenario	Cost Estimate	Basis
Optimistic (P10)	£21.5m	Minimal integration complexity
Base case (P50)	£24.1m	Expected delivery conditions
Control baseline (P80)	£26.8m	Recommended budget
Stress scenario (P95)	£30.2m	Reserve trigger threshold

Appendix B — Kerzner PMMM Assessment: Formula One

PMMM Level	Description	F1 Assessment
1 — Common Language	Basic PM terminology adopted	Achieved
2 — Common Processes	Repeatable PM processes established	Achieved

3 — Singular Methodology	Unified PM methodology	Achieved (race ops); Partial (marketing)
4 — Benchmarking	Continuous comparison with best practice	Achieved (operations); Emerging (marketing)
5 — Continuous Improvement	PM processes actively optimised	Emerging

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